Make Me One More Promise Before I Go

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/57603961.

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Not Rated

Archive Warning:
Major Character Death

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Character Death, Emotional Hurt, Regret, never ending love, Agony, Blood and Injury, Fear of Death, trying to hold on, Crying

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by flwrs_verse

Summary

Maybe the one thing Adora couldn't do, the one person she couldn't save, would end up being the most important.

Notes

I want to apologize in advance, I even cried a bit writing this. It probably doesn't help that I was listening to the album Agony by Take Care while writing this.

See the end of the work for more notes

It wasn't supposed to go this way. It was *never* supposed to go this way. They had just been on a mission. The best friends squad, as Bow always said. It was Adora, Catra, Glimmer, and Bow. It was a simple mission too. They were supposed to be in and out. Simple and quick. Then they would head back to Bright Moon. Back home.

They split up. Why did they split up? Adora and Catra went one way, Bow and Glimmer went the other. Now because of that Adora's entire future was collapsing.

They didn't see it. Why didn't they see it? They should have noticed how eerily quiet it was. If they hadn't been joking around and laughing while they were walking they would have noticed. If Glimmer and Bow had gone with them they would've had more backup…

If Glimmer and Bow had gone with them Catra wouldn't be dying.

Adora held the Magicat in her arms, fighting tears back. She needed to be strong, because maybe if she was strong Catra would be able to make it through this.

The logic wasn't strong but she was frantic, she was desperate. She would do anything to save her. Though, in the back of her mind she knew. She knew the wound was too big, it was too critical. In the back of her mind she knew she was the only one who was going to make it out alive. She'd eventually have to carry Catra's lifeless body back to Glimmer and Bow.

But maybe, maybe if she tried hard enough? Maybe if she used her magic. Yes! Her magic, how could she be so stupid.

Adora pressed her forehead to Catra's, shaking in her adrenaline fueled attempt to save Catra's life.

"Ad- Adora. What are y-you doing" Catra asked, voice weak and brittle. She was choking on her own words. Her hands grasped feebly at Adora's back.

"I'm healing you. You're going to be ok, you hear me? You are going to be ok. It's all going to be okay." Adora said, voice shaking and thick with emotion. She didn't even know who she was reassuring at this point. Adora felt relief course through her as she felt the magic starting to work. She was gonna get out of this with Catra alive. The magic was going to work.

She finally let herself cry as the magic ran its course. She found solace in feeling the magic course through her. She almost laughed in relief but was stopped in her tracks because something didn't feel right…

No.

The magic was starting to fade. No matter how hard she tried, it wasn't doing anything to help Catra. The wounds were too severe,

too life-threatening. It was something so horrendous that even her magic couldn't undo what was done.

"Catra" She sobbed, forehead still pressed against the other's.

"A-adora," Catra said weakly. "It isn't working, is it?" she said as she felt the magic start to grow dim despite Adora's distressed attempts to save her life. The magic faded and the all-consuming searing pain took its place once again.

All Adora could do was just solemnly nod her head as sobs racked her body.

"Catra, stay with me, ok? Listen, you are going to be alright" she cried. It didn't matter how many times Adora said that words couldn't save the love of her life. Words couldn't turn back time.

"I'm scared," Catra muttered as tears welled in her eyes. Her hands weakening and falling from their place on Adora's back.

"No. Catra, hold on, ok? Hold on, please. Please just hold on." Adora sobbed. She was rambling. Her pulse was loud in her ears and she could smell the metallic scent of Catra's blood everywhere. It soaked her clothes but she held onto the Magicat like she would never let go of her again.

“I’m, I’m trying” Catra said with a fragile voice as tears slowly fell down the sides of her face. They both knew she wasn’t going to make it. This was it, wasn’t it? “I love you, Adora” Catra said, voice now a whisper and it cracked due to the strain it took just to speak.

“No, no Catra.”

“Say it back, please”

Adora didn’t want to. Not because she didn’t love Catra, no she loved her more than anything or anyone in the entire universe. She didn’t want to say it because she didn’t want to admit this was the end. Because if she didn’t maybe she'd wake up and realize this had all just been a really bad dream. Catra will be cuddled up next to her in bed like every other night. Catra will hold her through her tears and reassure her this was all just a bad dream.

But she had too.

“I love you, Catra. More than anything.” It was almost incoherent with the way Adora tried to get it out in between sobs.

“Promise?”

“I promise”.

With that Catra fell limp in Adora's arms. "No, no, no, no, NO!" She screamed. Catra wasn't dead, she couldn't be dead.

But hoping won't change the fact that she's gone. Hoping won't put the sparkle, the light back into her eyes.

She's really gone. Adora doesn't know how long she stays curled over Catra's body, sobbing and whispering about all the things they were supposed to do. How they were supposed to see the world together, supposed to get married, they were going to have a kid. They were going to have a long life together.

But that all faded away right before Adora's eyes, and for the first time in her life there was truly nothing she could do to help.

End Notes

Comments and kudos are greatly appreciated! I'd love to know how you liked the fic. There will be more (much less sad) fics in the future!

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Twitter: https://x.com/urlocaldyk3
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